

Blockposter

The cost of a simple A2 size poster (four times the area of the conventional A4) can set you back by anything from Rs. 2,00 to Rs. 1,000. So how cool would it be if you could simply print your own giant-sized poster?

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www.blockposters.com allows you to create your own giant-sized posters, and more importantly customise the content and the size so that it fits your wall. It allows you to upload an image on to the server, resizes the image, enlarges it and gives you a link where you can download the stretched image as a series of A4 size sheets.

The interface is extremely simple and easy to use. On the main page of the site, click on **Step 1** to get started. Most photographs or pics

are smaller in size. However, if you find an image that is larger, you can always down-size it using programs like Photoshop or IrfanView.

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Click on **Browse** to locate the file on your computer. Click on **Upload**. This depends on your internet connection and the size of the file. We played around with an image from a comic book.

You then have to decide how wide you want your poster to be. The width is an integral multiple of the width of the standard A4 size sheet. So, it's advisable to figure out the space constraints on your wall. An A4 sheet is 11.54 inches high (approximately one foot).

If you're unsure of the size, feel free to experiment. As you vary your selection, the site will tell you how large your

poster will be. We selected five A4 sheets, in the landscape position (horizontal) to arrive at a size of around 5 feet x 3.9 feet.

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Your poster is split as PDF files. The PDF we downloaded was 3.3 MB, approximately 3.5 times the size of my original picture.

The images you download will be pixelated. That is, on close view, the image will not be of extremely high quality. The amount of blur that is visible on close range depends solely on the size of your image uploaded and how blown up you want your poster to be. Each page has borders. You may need to trim the image a little after printing to take care of the borders, though again, if you have no borders, the images might tend to overlap a little.

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Stick the A4 size sheets sequentially on your wall using tape or glue.

Blocky images are considered quite artistic, so if you are of the same opinion, you won't mind a mildly pixelated image of your favourite icon or landscape scene.

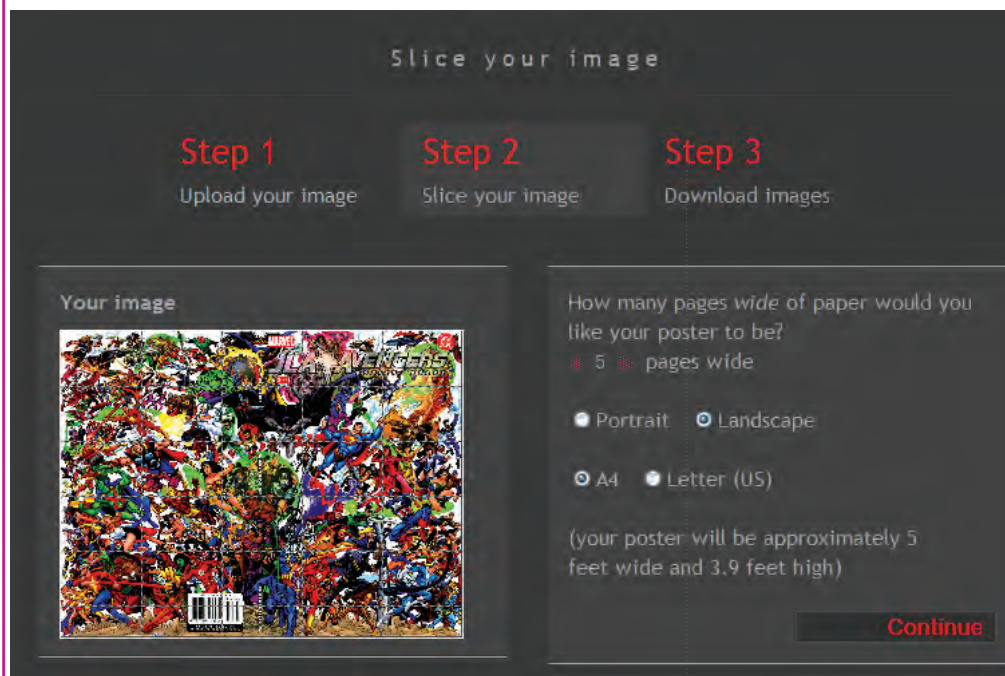
Now, the best part of the site is that it's completely customisable. Also, most sites that allow any degree of customisation have ads or embedded logos on the customised items. The image we printed was spread across 30 pages. Effectively, the cost of your poster is printing costs for 30 A4 sheets.

The entire process doesn't exceed 15 minutes. However, printing, trimming and putting the poster up may take you up to an hour, but it's easier than shopping online for artwork. Blockposters works whether you want to upload a photograph or a scenic landscape. Also, sites like www.deviantart.com have a lot of fan submitted artwork for your favourite books, movies or series.

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Once you've put your poster up on your wall, take a picture and upload it to the blockposters gallery (<http://www.blockposters.com/gallery.aspx>).

The gallery will give you a decent idea of how good the pictures look when put up in your homes. It also showcases some of the most creative designs and applications of the software with user comments.



The screenshot shows the 'Slice your image' interface. At the top, there are three steps: 'Step 1 Upload your image', 'Step 2 Slice your image', and 'Step 3 Download images'. Below 'Step 1', there is a section titled 'Your image' showing a colorful, abstract image. To the right of the image, there are options for 'How many pages wide of paper would you like your poster to be?' with a value of '5' and 'pages wide'. Below this, there are radio buttons for 'Portrait' and 'Landscape', with 'Landscape' selected. There are also radio buttons for 'A4' and 'Letter (US)', with 'A4' selected. A note below these options states: '(your poster will be approximately 5 feet wide and 3.9 feet high)'. At the bottom right, there is a 'Continue' button.

Slice your images